

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Netanyahu hints at more Gaza action

Ex-intelligence chief calls prime minister's objectives 'fantasy'

By **Julia Frankel** and **Wafaa Shurafa**
Associated Press

JERUSALEM — Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu hinted at wider military action in devastated Gaza on Tuesday, even as former Israeli army and intelligence chiefs called for an end to the nearly 22-month war.

The new pressure on Netanyahu came as Gaza's Health Ministry said the Palestinian death toll had surpassed 61,000. Health officials reported new deaths of hungry Palestinians seeking food at distribution points. As desperation mounts, the Israeli defense body coordinating aid announced a deal with local merchants to improve deliveries.

Among those speaking out were former leaders of Israel's Shin Bet internal security service, Mossad spy agency and the military — and also ex-Prime Minister Ehud Barak. In a video posted to social media this week, they said far-right members of the government are holding Israel "hostage" in prolonging the conflict.

Netanyahu's objectives in Gaza are "a fantasy," Yoram Cohen, former head of Shin Bet, said in the video.

"If anyone imagines that we can reach every terrorist and every pit and every weapon, and in parallel bring our hostages home — I think it is impossible," he said.

Netanyahu convened his Security Cabinet to direct the military on the war's next stage, hinting that even tougher action was possible. But the meeting wrapped up hours later without any announcements about Israel's plans.

Netanyahu said his objectives include defeating Hamas, releasing all 50 remaining hostages and ensuring Gaza never again threatens Israel after the Hamas-led 2023 attack sparked the war.

Israeli media reported disagree-

Turn to Gaza, Page 14

'COMED FOUR' BRIBERY TRIAL



Jay Doherty, former City Club of Chicago president, leaves the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse on Tuesday after being sentenced. **BRIAN CASSELLA/TRIBUNE**

Consultant sentenced to one year in prison

Connection to upper crust of political world ended up being Doherty's downfall

By **Jason Meisner**
Chicago Tribune

Consultant Jay Doherty spent years as the face of the vaunted City Club of Chicago, glad-handing with a who's who of the city's power set at public luncheons, where he often plugged the utility giant he counted as his biggest client: Commonwealth Edison.

But it was that connection to the upper crust of Chicago political world — and the hidden deals happening underneath —

that wound up being Doherty's downfall.

On Tuesday, more than two years after his conviction in the "ComEd Four" bribery trial, Doherty told a federal judge his skills for bringing people together served him well in his career and charitable work, but that somehow he lost his way.

"Sometime over the years, instead of seeing my job as a means of service, it became simply a way to make more money and build myself up. To

gain, not give," Doherty said, standing at the lectern in a rumpled blue suit and reading from notes in a clear voice. "This happened so slowly, your honor, over time, that to be honest I did not see this even within myself, and I am deeply ashamed that I did not see it."

Doherty stopped short of admitting he'd committed any crime. In sentencing Doherty to a year in prison, however, U.S. District Judge Manish Shah said that while Doherty's statement

was admirable, his role in the case was more than just some moral lapse.

By agreeing to be a pass-through for secret payments to associates of then-House Speaker Michael Madigan, Doherty and his eponymous consulting firm "were the metaphoric cash in an envelope that amounted to bribes," corrupting the state's legislative process and Doherty's own penchant for bringing

Turn to Doherty, Page 2



Jayden Perkins' family reacts after Crosetti Brand was sentenced to life in prison in the boy's death on Tuesday at the Leighton Criminal Court Building. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Man sentenced to life in prison in fatal stabbing of 11-year-old

Boy was protecting his pregnant mother from vicious attack

By **Madeline Buckley**
Chicago Tribune

For most of his adult life, Crosetti Brand terrorized and abused women, prosecutors said, until a brave 11-year-old boy stopped him for good.

Not yet a teenager, Jayden Perkins was forced to protect his pregnant mother from a vicious attack on March 13, 2024, in their

Edgewater apartment. Jayden died of his stab wounds, but his mother lived to later gave birth to his younger sister and testified against their assailant, helping to put Brand, 39, in prison for the rest of his life.

Calling the slaying "exceptionally brutal," Judge Angela Petrone sentenced Brand on Tuesday to the maximum possible punishment, a life sentence plus an additional 120 years in prison following an emotional hearing at the Leighton Criminal Court Building.

"You have taken away one of

the greatest gifts God has blessed me with," Jayden's mother, Latoria Smith said in court. "He was a great kid. He saw what was happening and tried to help me."

The sentencing in front of a courtroom full of family members closed the book on the case that drew scrutiny over safeguards meant to protect domestic violence victims and proceeded to trial at a pace nearly unheard of in a county where it can take years, or even a decade, for murder cases to resolve.

Turn to Sentence, Page 4

Law would expand reach of personal injury attorneys

Tied to legal action over toxic substances; proposal to Pritzker

By **Robert McCoppin**
Chicago Tribune

A proposed law on the governor's desk would expand the reach of personal injury lawyers, allowing them to file suit against any business operating in Illinois that exposes individuals to toxic substances — even if the company and the plaintiffs are based in another state.

Trial lawyers say the measure would offer fairness and convenience, primarily for Illinois residents who are injured in other states. Traditionally those plaintiffs have had to file suit in

the state where they were hurt or where the company is headquartered.

Critics warn the legal change would promote "venue shopping" — where plaintiffs look for the most favorable court in which to file suit — a practice that, in theory, is not permitted. If approved, Illinois would be one of the first states to adopt such an approach, said Mark Denzler, president of the Illinois Manufacturers' Association.

"This is only for wealthy trial lawyers," Denzler said. "There's no benefit to Illinois residents because they already have access to these courts. This will create an economic black eye for Illinois. It will clog up the courts."

Turn to Proposal, Page 4

INSIDE

'We thought it was the right risk'

The Cubs' trade deadline gamble on Michael Soroka is not paying off so far. **Chicago Sports**



This little piggy went to Pilsen

Cerdito Muerto, a cocktail bar and Mexican American kitchen, transforms an old family home in the neighborhood. **Food & Health**

TODAY'S WEATHER High **87** Low **71**

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 24

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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